📘 Banking/Finance/Economy — Chapter Notes

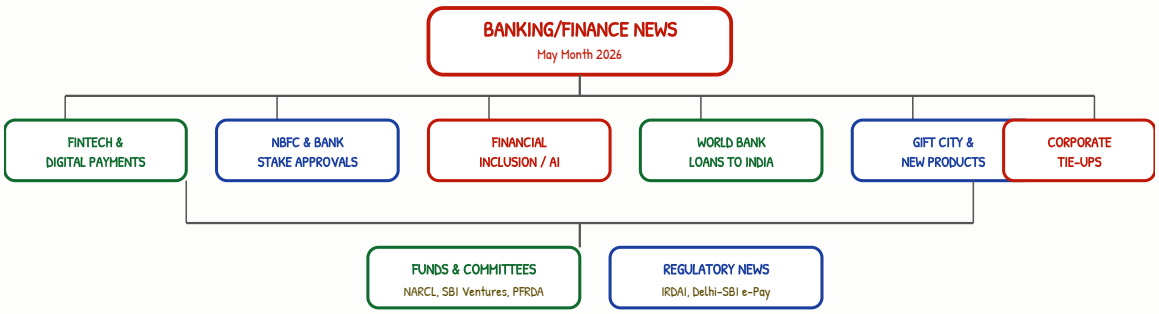
Banking News

✍️ *Topper's Handwritten Revision Notes — May Month Current Affairs by Abhijit Sir*

🎯 Chapter Snapshot

May month covers **19 Banking/Finance events** *across* **Fintech Innovation**, **NBFC/Stake Approvals**, **Financial Inclusion**, **World Bank Loans**, **New Products**, **GIFT City**, **Funds & Committees** *and* **Regulatory News** *— very high exam weightage!*

🗺️ Master Mind Map



Note: Group all 19 news items under these 8 buckets →
Sector-wise recall is faster than event-wise recall!

19 NEWS ITEMS — QUICK INDEX

1. Flipkart-Axis-PayU Biometric Auth
2. MobiKwik NBFC Approval
3. IPPB SHG Savings Account
4. NARCL Recovery FY26
5. World Bank – Gurugram Metro
6. Jio Payments Bank-Ezeepay
7. Bihar-World Bank Loan
8. KMBL stake in AU SFB/Federal
9. AU SFB 4 New Credit Cards
10. CTBC Bank – GIFT City
11. ICICI-Visa USD Debit Card
12. Assam – AI Phygital Branch
13. Viyona Fintech – NPCI Cert
14. FinBox – Atlas AI Platform
15. Mahindra-DBS Dealer Financing
16. SBI Ventures-Maritime Fund
17. PFRDA – SAARG Committee
18. Delhi Govt-SBI e-Pay MoU
19. IRDAI – Ombudsman FY26

📘 Topic 1 · Fintech & Digital Payments

Fintech & Digital Payments Innovation

➤ 1️⃣ Flipkart, Axis Bank & PayU — Biometric Card Payments

🔴 Headline

Flipkart, partnered with **Axis Bank** *&* **PayU**, *launched* **biometric authentication** *for card payments — approve via fingerprint/Face ID instead of OTP.*

फ्लिपकार्ट, एक्सिस बैंक और पेयू ने OTP-फ्री कार्ड पेमेंट के लिए बायोमेट्रिक ऑथेंटिकेशन लॉन्च किया।

💡 *Aligns with* **RBI's Authentication Mechanisms for Digital Payment Transactions Directions, 2025**

➤ 2️⃣ Jio Payments Bank × Ezeepay Partnership

🔴 Headline

Jio Payments Bank Limited (JPBL) partnered with fintech platform **Ezeepay** *as* **Business Correspondent (BC)** *to strengthen last-mile digital banking in rural & semi-urban India.*

✔ **Goal:** *Expand basic banking access through local merchant outlets.*

➤ 3️⃣ Viyona Fintech Gets NPCI Certification

Particular	Detail
Company	**Viyona Fintech India Pvt. Ltd. (Hyderabad)**
Certified By	**NPCI (National Payments Corporation of India)**
Certifications	*UPI Acquirer, UPI Issuer, IMPS, IBMB (Interoperable Mobile Banking)*

➤ 4️⃣ FinBox Launches AI Platform 'Atlas'

🔴 Headline

FinBox launched **Atlas** *— an AI-lending infrastructure platform that cuts loan processing time from* **~3 weeks to 24 hours**.

✔ **Key Stat:** *~70% of loan applications drop off before completion — Atlas aims to fix this.*

Topic 2 · NBFC & Bank Stake Approvals

NBFC & Bank Stake Approvals

➤ 1️⃣ MobiKwik Secures NBFC Approval from RBI

🔴 Headline

RBI approved MobiKwik's ***NBFC (Non-Banking Financial Company)*** *application, allowing entry into regulated lending business.*

Particular	Detail
Approval By	***Reserve Bank of India (RBI)***
Subsidiary Formed	***MobiKwik Financial Services Pvt. Ltd. (MFSPL)***
Condition	*Subject to receiving Certificate of Registration (CoR) from RBI*

➤ 2️⃣ KMBL Gets RBI Nod for Stake in AU SFB & Federal Bank

🔴 Headline

Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd (KMBL) *got RBI approval to acquire up to* ***9.99%*** *stake (paid-up capital / voting rights) each in* ***AU Small Finance Bank*** *and* ***Federal Bank***.

KMBL को AU SFB और Federal Bank में 9.99% हिस्सेदारी खरीदने के लिए RBI से मंज़ूरी मिली।

⚡ Quick Table

Acquirer	Target Banks	Max Stake
Kotak Mahindra Bank (KMBL)	*AU Small Finance Bank + Federal Bank*	***9.99% each***

🧠 **Trick:** *"Mobi Kotak — NBFC, Nine-point-nine-nine"* → ***MobiKwik = NBFC approval | Kotak = 9.99% stake approval***

💡 *Both approvals show RBI's dual role: licensing new NBFCs AND regulating cross-bank stake acquisitions.*

Financial Inclusion & AI-Powered Banking

➤ 1️⃣ India Post Payments Bank — SHG Savings Account

🔴 Headline

IPPB *(100% Govt of India owned, under Dept. of Posts) launched* **Self Help Group (SHG) Savings Account** *to boost financial inclusion & women empowerment in rural India.*

⚡ Key Features

Feature	Detail
Balance/Charges	**Zero balance, zero charges**
Minimum Initial Deposit	None required
Monthly Average Balance (MAB)	Not required
Max Balance Limit	**₹2,00,000**
Interest Payout	Quarterly, as per applicable savings rates

🧠 **Trick:** *"Zero-Zero, 2 Lakh Limit"* → **Zero balance-Zero charge, ₹2,00,000 max balance for IPPB SHG A/c**

➤ 2️⃣ Assam — India's 1st AI-Powered Phygital Bank Branch

🔴 Headline

Assam CM **Himanta Biswa Sarma** *inaugurated India's* **1st AI-powered 'Phygital'** *banking branch of* **Slice Small Finance Bank** *in Guwahati.*

असम के मुख्यमंत्री हिमंत बिस्वा सरमा ने गुवाहाटी में भारत की पहली AI-संचालित फिजिटल बैंक शाखा का उद्घाटन किया।

Particular	Detail
Meaning of 'Phygital'	Physical banking infra + advanced digital technology
Bank	**Slice Small Finance Bank**
ESTD / HQ / CEO	2016 / Guwahati, Assam / Rajan Bajaj

Topic 4 · World Bank Loans

World Bank Loans to India

➤ 1️⃣ Gurugram Metro Phase II

Particular	Detail
Loan Amount	**₹2,800 crore**
Given To	**Gurugram Metropolitan Rail Limited**
Given By	World Bank
Extra Info	Loan constitutes 60% of the project cost

➤ 2️⃣ Bihar Urban Transformation Programme

Particular	Detail
Loan Amount	**USD 500 million (₹4,750 crore)**
Given To	**Bihar (State Govt.)**
Given By	World Bank
Objective	Bihar Urban Transformation Programme
Extra Info	Follows plan for 11 new greenfield satellite townships in Bihar

✔ Concept Note: **Greenfield Project** = new city built from scratch on vacant/rural land. **Satellite Township** = self-sufficient smaller town near a major city (e.g. Patna) to reduce congestion.

➤ 🌍 About World Bank

Particular	Detail
ESTD	**1944**
HQ	**Washington DC, USA**
Members	**189**
World Bank Group (5 Institutions)	**IBRD, IDA, IFC, MIGA, ICSID**
President	Ajay Banga

Topic 5 · GIFT City & New Products

GIFT City News & New Banking Products

➤ 1️⃣ CTBC Bank — First Taiwanese Bank at GIFT City

Headline

CTBC Bank became the **first Taiwanese bank** to open a branch at **GIFT City, Gujarat** — and remains the only Taiwanese bank present anywhere in India.

💡 Branch established after approval from **IFSCA** (International Financial Services Centres Authority)

➤ 2️⃣ ICICI Bank & Visa — India's First USD-Denominated Debit Card

Headline

ICICI Bank + Visa launched India's **first USD-denominated debit card** for NRI customers, issued from ICICI's **IFSC Banking Unit (IBU)** at GIFT City.

Particular	Detail
Linked To	ICICI Bank's USD Global Savings Account
Platform	**Visa Infinite (Premium)**
ICICI Bank — ESTD/HQ/MD/Tagline	1955 / Mumbai / Sandeep Bakhshi / "Hum Hain Na"

🧠 **Trick — GIFT City 2 Firsts:** "CTBC = Country First (Taiwan) | ICICI = Instrument First (USD Card)" → **CTBC-1st Taiwanese Bank | ICICI-1st USD Debit Card**

➤ 3️⃣ AU Small Finance Bank — 4 New Credit Cards

Card	Target Segment	Key Benefit
AU Ananta	Affluent achievers	Premium travel, lounge access, no-cost EMI
AU Laksya	Gen Z / mid-career	Cashbacks, BOGO movies, lounge access
AU Tejas	Young salaried	Cashback on daily spends, welcome rewards
AU Prathama	First-time credit users	Balance transfer offers, fuel surcharge waiver

✔ **Revision Point:** CheQ + AU SFB launched 'CheQ AU Credit Card' — India's first co-branded LED-powered credit card.

AU SFB	Detail

Corporate Tie-ups & Stressed Asset Recovery

➤ 1️⃣ Mahindra & Mahindra × DBS Bank India

🔴 Headline

Mahindra & Mahindra + DBS Bank India signed an ***MoU*** *to launch India's* ***first sustainability-linked dealer financing programme*** *in the automotive sector.*

💡 *Loan interest rates for authorised Mahindra dealers linked to* ***ESG performance*** *+ sales targets — ESG metrics jointly designed by both partners.*

➤ 2️⃣ NARCL Recovery — FY 2025-26

🔴 Headline

National Asset Reconstruction Company Ltd (NARCL) *recovered over* ***₹4,364 crore*** *in FY 2025-26 — about 70% of its total recoveries (now ₹6,345 crore).*

⚡ **Quick Revision Table**

Particular	Figure
Recovery in FY26	₹4,364+ crore
Total Recoveries so far	₹6,345 crore
Borrower Entities Acquired	33
Debt Exposure Acquired	~₹1.65 lakh crore (target ₹2 lakh crore)
Accounts with Recoveries	23
Recovery % of Acquisition Cost	>48%
ESTD / HQ / MD & CEO	7 July 2021 / Mumbai / P. Santosh

🧠 **Trick — NARCL numbers:** *"**33** borrowers, **23** accounts, **48%** recovery, **2** lakh Cr target" → **33-23-48-2 formula***

Funds, Committees & Regulatory Updates

➤ 1️⃣ SBI Ventures — Maritime Investment Fund (MIF)

Particular	Detail
Fund Manager Appointed	**SBI Ventures**
Fund Size	**₹20,000 crore (Maritime Investment Fund)**
Part Of	₹25,000 crore Maritime Development Fund (Union Cabinet approved)
Central Govt Contribution	**₹9,800 crore (49%)**
Remaining 51%	Private investors, sovereign wealth funds, CPSEs, PSUs, port authorities
Registration	Closed-end Category I/II AIF under SEBI

➤ 2️⃣ PFRDA — SAARG Committee for New Asset Classes

🔴 Headline

*PFRDA formed a committee to examine **new asset classes** to enhance pension returns under NPS.*

Particular	Detail
Committee Name	**SAARG — Strategic Asset Allocation & Risk Governance**
Formed By	PFRDA
Chairman	**Narayan Ramachandran**
NPS Subscribers (FY26)	**2.17 crore**
NPS Total Corpus	**~₹15.95 lakh crore**
PFRDA — ESTD/HQ/Chairman	2003 / New Delhi / S. Ramann

➤ 3️⃣ Delhi Govt × SBI — e-Pay System MoU

✔ **Note:** Delhi e-Governance Society signed MoU with SBI to launch "e-Pay" — an integrated electronic payment system on Delhi Govt's e-procurement portal (faster, transparent, paperless).

➤ 4️⃣ IRDAI — Insurance Ombudsman Report FY26

Particular	Detail
Complaints Resolved	41,055 (FY 2025-26)
Decisions in Favour of Policyholders	~79%
Ombudsman Centres in India	18
Claim Limit Handled	Up to ₹50 lakh

🧠 **Trick — IRDAI numbers:** "41K complaints, 79%, 18 centres, 50L limit" → **41,055-79%-18-₹50L formula**

Final Revision

🎯 One-Page Master Summary

⚡ All 19 Events at a Glance

#	Event	Key Entity
1	Biometric OTP-free card payments	Flipkart, Axis Bank, PayU
2	NBFC approval	MobiKwik (RBI)
3	SHG Savings Account	India Post Payments Bank
4	Recovery ₹4,364 Cr in FY26	NARCL
5	₹2,800 Cr loan – Gurugram Metro	World Bank
6	Business Correspondent tie-up	Jio Payments Bank + Ezeepay
7	USD 500 Mn loan – Urban Transformation	Bihar + World Bank
8	9.99% stake in AU SFB & Federal Bank	Kotak Mahindra Bank (KMBL)
9	4 new credit cards	AU Small Finance Bank
10	1st Taiwanese bank at GIFT City	CTBC Bank
11	1st USD-denominated debit card	ICICI Bank + Visa
12	1st AI-powered Phygital branch	Slice SFB, Guwahati (Assam CM)
13	NPCI certification (UPI/IMPS/IBMB)	Viyona Fintech
14	AI lending platform 'Atlas'	FinBox
15	1st sustainability-linked dealer financing	Mahindra & Mahindra + DBS Bank
16	₹20,000 Cr Maritime Investment Fund	SBI Ventures
17	SAARG Committee for NPS asset classes	PFRDA
18	"e-Pay" MoU for e-procurement	Delhi Govt + SBI
19	41,055 complaints resolved (FY26)	IRDAI – Insurance Ombudsman

⚡ Numbers Master List

Item	Figure
KMBL stake in AU SFB / Federal Bank	**9.99% each**
IPPB SHG A/c max balance	**₹2,00,000**
NARCL FY26 recovery / total	**₹4,364 Cr / ₹6,345 Cr**
Gurugram Metro loan	**₹2,800 Cr (60% of project cost)**

Bihar Urban loan	USD 500 Mn (₹4,750 Cr)
SBI Ventures Maritime Fund	₹20,000 Cr (of ₹25,000 Cr total)
NPS subscribers / corpus (FY26)	2.17 Cr / ₹15.95 lakh Cr
IRDAI complaints resolved	41,055 (79% in favour, 18 centres)

🧠 **Master Mnemonic:** "Flip Mobi India NARCL World Jio Bihar Kotak" → **Chain the first 8 events in listed order for fast recall!**

✅ Chapter Complete — Revise this page 1 day before exam!